

Hacker Holidays 2026 – Day 8

Towel on the Sunbed

TODAY'S ITINERARY

- ☐ Create a guest account and explore Ponzi's daily reward mechanism.
- ☐ Work out exactly what's standing between you and Whale Vault status.
- ☐ Find your way past it and retrieve the flag from the vault.

In this challenge for the Hacker Holidays, we're asked to exploit web app's one-time reward function

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Staking Rewards

Earn **50 PONZI** every 24 hours by claiming your staking reward.

Reward is available to claim now.

Claim Reward

Once in the app, we have to register a user, then use the Claim Reward button to get 50 PONZI. Our goal is to get 150 PONZI to complete the challenge

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Staking Rewards

Earn **50 PONZI** every 24 hours by claiming your staking reward.

Next claim in: 23:59:49

Claim Reward

After clicking the Claim Reward button the first time, it becomes unavailable for 24 hours, but we can't wait that long

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Staking Rewards

Earn **50 PONZI** every 24 hours by claiming your staking reward.

Next claim in: 23:59:49

[Claim Reward](#)

When web app security testing, when we come across any promo codes or discount codes, we have to test whether applying these codes is vulnerable to a race condition exploit

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1. Check if the promo has been used before
2. Give currency to account
3. Flag promo code as used

A simplified version of the steps for applying a discount code are illustrated above

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1. Check if the promo has been used before
2. Give currency to account
3. Flag promo code as used

If the function that applies the code isn't coded securely, it may allow multiple promo codes to be applied before flagging the promo code as used: a race condition exploit

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1. Create a new account
2. Send three promo code redeems at once
3. Get the flag

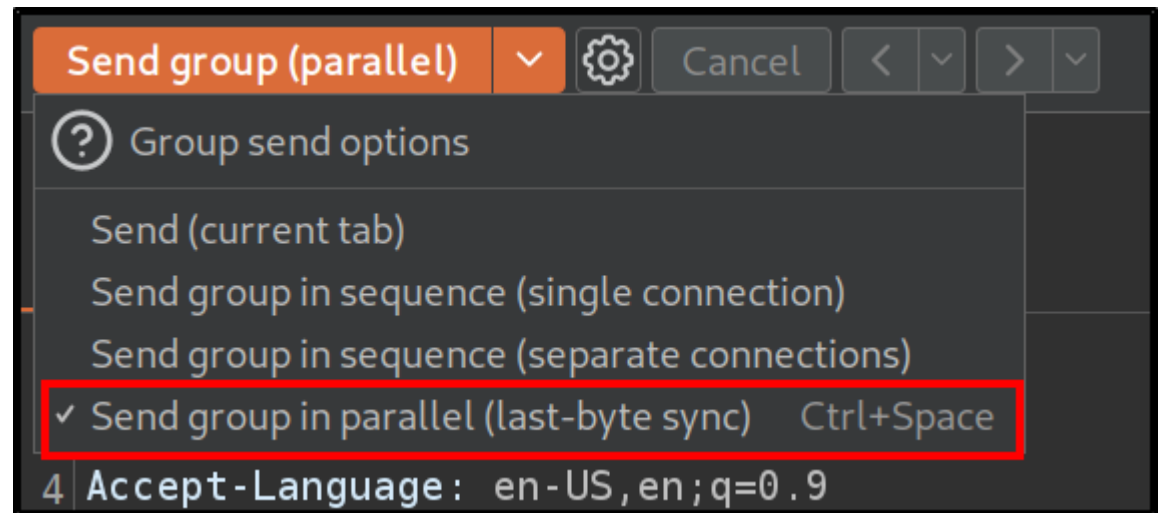
We'll follow the following steps to exploit the race condition on the web app and finish the challenge

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Request

	Pretty	Raw	Hex
1	POST /claim HTTP/1.1		
2	Host: 10.146.134.223:3000		
3	Content-Length: 0		
4	Accept-Language: en-US,en;q=0.9		



Using Burp Suite, we can copy the promo redeem request multiple times, then send them all at once